

Locating Executable Files in an Extracted Cyberpunk 2077 Installation: A Recursive Glob Audit of the Game Tree and Redist Folder

[Author placeholder]
[author@example.com]

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Abstract

This paper documents a systematic audit of executable (“`.exe`”) files within an extracted Cyberpunk 2077 game installation located at `/Volumes/One Touch/mdata/games/cbp/Cyberpunk 2077/`. The installation was previously extracted from a zstd-compressed ZIP archive in prior session work. A recursive glob search with the pattern `**/*.exe` was executed over the game tree and, separately, over the `Redist` folder. The audit identified 12 executables in total: 7 game-related binaries within the game tree and 5 redistributable runtime installers within `Redist/`. The observed layout is consistent with a standard pre-installed Cyberpunk 2077 repack, with game binaries under `bin/x64`, modding tools under `tools/redmod/bin`, and redistributable runtimes under `Redist/`. The primary launcher of interest is `Cyberpunk2077.exe`, with `Run Me!.bat` available for the setup steps.

1 Introduction

Pre-installed (“repacked”) game distributions are typically delivered as a single archive that, once extracted, must be verified before use: the user needs to confirm that the installation is complete, identify which executable launches the game, and distinguish game binaries from the runtime dependencies that merely support them. After a large game archive has been extracted, a first-order integrity check is to enumerate the executable files present in the installation tree and to map them to their roles.

This paper reports such an audit for a Cyberpunk 2077 installation that was extracted from a zstd-compressed ZIP archive in prior session work (see Section 2). The extracted game tree resides at `/Volumes/One Touch/mdata/games/cbp/Cyberpunk 2077/`. The session that produced this paper pursued the following research questions:

1. **RQ1.** Which executable (“`.exe`”) files are present in the extracted installation, and where are they located?
2. **RQ2.** Which of these executables are game binaries, and which are redistributable runtime dependencies?
3. **RQ3.** Which executable serves as the primary launcher of the game?

The remainder of this paper is organized as follows. Section 2 summarizes the prior extraction work that produced the installation under audit. Section 3 describes the search procedure. Section 4 reports the executables found, and Section 5 interprets the resulting layout. Section 6 concludes.

2 Background

The installation under audit was produced in prior session work, in which the Cyberpunk 2077 game archive was extracted from a zstd-compressed ZIP archive. The extraction target was `/Volumes/One Touch/mdata/games/cbp/Cyberpunk 2077/` on an external drive. The present session is a follow-up: it does not re-examine the extraction itself, but audits the resulting installation tree to locate all executable files and to identify the launcher.

3 Methods

3.1 Search procedure

Executable files were located by recursive glob search using the pattern `**/*.exe`, which matches every file whose name ends in `.exe` at any depth of the directory tree. Two searches were performed:

- **Game tree.** A recursive glob search over the full game tree at `/Volumes/One Touch/mdata/games/cbp/Cyberpunk 2077/`.
- **Redist folder.** A separate recursive glob search over the `Redist` folder, which in pre-installed distributions typically holds redistributable runtime installers rather than game binaries.

3.2 Scope and limitations

The audit is limited to filename-based enumeration: it establishes the presence and location of executable files but performs no binary inspection, no integrity verification, and no execution of any of the files found. The classification of executables into roles (game binary, launcher, modding tool, runtime dependency) is based on their paths and names within the standard installation layout.

4 Results

4.1 Executables in the game tree

The recursive glob search over the game tree returned 7 executables. They are listed in Table 1, grouped by their role.

Table 1: Executables found in the game tree (7 files).

Executable	Location	Role
Cyberpunk2077.exe	bin/x64/	Main game executable (launcher of interest)
REDprelauncher.exe	game root	Launcher
REDEngineErrorReporter.exe	bin/x64/	Error reporting
CrashReporter.exe	bin/x64/CrashReporter/	Crash reporting
7za.exe	bin/x64/CrashReporter/	Archive utility
redMod.exe	tools/redmod/bin/	Modding tool
scc.exe	tools/redmod/bin/	Modding tool

4.2 Executables in the Redist folder

The separate search over the `Redist` folder returned 5 executables. These are runtime dependencies rather than game binaries. They are listed in Table 2.

Table 2: Executables found in the `Redist` folder (5 files).

Executable	Location	Role
<code>vc_redist.x64.exe</code>	<code>Redist/</code>	Visual C++ runtime (x64)
<code>vc_redist.x86.exe</code>	<code>Redist/</code>	Visual C++ runtime (x86)
<code>PhysX_9.08.14_9.09.0814_SystemSoftware.exe</code>	<code>Redist/</code>	PhysX system software
<code>DXWebSetup.exe</code>	<code>Redist/</code>	DirectX web installer
<code>DXSETUP.exe</code>	<code>Redist/DirectX/</code>	DirectX setup

4.3 Summary

In total, the audit located 12 executable files: 7 within the game tree and 5 within the `Redist` folder. The launcher of interest is `Cyberpunk2077.exe` (located at `bin/x64/Cyberpunk2077.exe`); for the setup steps, `Run Me!.bat` is available.

5 Discussion

The observed executable layout matches the convention of a standard pre-installed Cyberpunk 2077 repack. Three structural observations follow.

First, the game binaries are concentrated under `bin/x64`: the main executable `Cyberpunk2077.exe`, the error reporter, and the crash reporter all reside there, with the launcher `REDprelauncher.exe` at the game root. This separation of launcher and game binary is typical of CD Projekt RED’s distribution layout.

Second, the modding toolchain is isolated under `tools/redmod/bin`, containing `redMod.exe` and `scc.exe`. Their presence confirms that the repack ships the REDmod tooling alongside the game rather than requiring a separate download.

Third, the `Redist` folder contains only runtime dependencies—Visual C++ redistributables, the PhysX system software, and DirectX installers—and no game code. These files support the game’s execution but are not part of the game itself, which is consistent with the role of a redistributables folder in pre-installed distributions.

The identification of `Cyberpunk2077.exe` as the launcher of interest answers RQ3 directly; `Run Me!.bat` serves the setup steps that precede first launch. The primary limitation of this study is that it is a single instance: the findings describe one installation on one volume and were obtained by filename enumeration only, without integrity or execution checks.

6 Conclusion

This paper documented a recursive glob audit of executable files in an extracted Cyberpunk 2077 installation. The audit located 12 executables in total: 7 game-related binaries in the game tree and 5 redistributable runtime installers in the `Redist` folder. The layout is consistent with a standard pre-installed repack, with game binaries under `bin/x64`, modding tools under `tools/redmod/bin`,

and runtime dependencies under `Redist/`. The primary launcher of interest is `Cyberpunk2077.exe`, with `Run Me!.bat` available for the setup steps.

References

- [1] Prior session work (unpublished session notes): extraction of the Cyberpunk 2077 game archive from a zstd-compressed ZIP archive to `/Volumes/One Touch/mdata/games/cbp/Cyberpunk 2077/`.